

Prosecutor says driver hunted, killed art benefactor

Murder defendant sent for psychiatric evaluation

By Brian MacQuarrie, Malcolm Gay, and Murray Whyte

GLOBE STAFF

Prominent art collector John Axelrod, strolling Saturday morning on the Commonwealth Avenue Mall, died in a targeted attack by a Back Bay man who sought out the victim, accelerated as he drove onto the mall, and deliberately ran over Axelrod and his dog, authorities said Monday.

"This was not a motor vehicle accident," prosecutor Ursula Knight said as William Haney Jr., appearing dazed and disheveled, was arraigned in Boston Municipal Court. "It was deliberate and premeditated murder."

A not-guilty plea for first-degree murder and animal cruelty was entered for Haney, 42, who stood motionless as Judge Joseph Griffin ordered him held without bail and taken to Bridgewater State Hospital for psychiatric evaluation.

Haney's attorney said outside the courtroom that his client has struggled for most of his adult life with serious mental illness, believed people were out to harm him, and might have mistaken Axelrod, 79, for someone else.

"I'm not aware of any evidence he knew of Mr. Axelrod," said Keith Halpern, the defense attorney.

Prosecutors, however, said Axelrod's death was not a random tragedy.

Before striking Axelrod, Knight said, Haney drove from his home on Marlborough Street, stopped a passerby, and asked "if he had seen an individual who was wearing a red jacket and with his dog."

"He used a derogatory term in referring to the

ARRAIGN, Page A10

Rising health insurance fees slam schools

Some districts forced to cut staff, seek tax hike

By James Vaznis

GLOBE STAFF

Escalating health insurance costs turned into a budget nightmare this academic year for Pioneer Valley Regional School District Superintendent Patricia Kinsella. Between July and October, her district got hit with two double-digit increases, totaling nearly 40 percent.

The double whammy forced the district to lay off a librarian and eliminate three vacant positions. Paychecks for teachers and other employees who earn below statewide averages also shrank as they shouldered their portion of the premium increases.

"These were heartbreaking cuts to make," Kinsella said. "None of us felt good about it."

Across Massachusetts, school districts and municipalities are grappling with hefty health insurance increases, typically between 10 and 20 percent, and sometimes more. The higher costs are pushing up annual health insurance spending by hundreds of thousands or millions of dollars.

Most communities got hit with the steep increases over the past year or so, following gradual growth in costs through the years. The larger numbers are expected to persist into the next fiscal year and possibly beyond.

The higher costs, coming as municipalities and districts are experiencing growing expendi-

INSURANCE, Page A5

Maduro, calling self a POW, arraigned as drug kingpin

Captured Venezuelan leader defiant as US makes case against him and his wife



VINCENT ALBAN/NEW YORK TIMES

Nicolás Maduro, ousted Venezuelan leader, and his wife, Cilia Flores, were taken off a helicopter en route to the US courthouse in Manhattan.

By Jonah E. Bromwich, Benjamin Weiser and Maia Coleman

NEW YORK TIMES

Two days after being ripped from a compound in Caracas, Venezuela, Nicolás Maduro, the captive president of Venezuela, appeared in a New York City courthouse and pleaded not guilty to federal charges, declaring himself a "prisoner of war."

Maduro, who was seized by Army Delta Force commandos Saturday and transported to the United States, wore a navy shirt over or-

Allies criticize US

Participants in an emergency meeting of the UN Security Council said the seizure of Venezuela's president was a violation of international law. **A6.**

Pain and promise

A formerly imprisoned dissident says there's something he hasn't seen in awhile on Venezuela's horizon: hope. **B1.**

ange prison garb and headphones for translation. He blinked in the bright lights of the courtroom as he was asked for his plea.

"I'm innocent. I'm not guilty. I am a decent man. I am still the president of my country," he said in Spanish, formally entering a plea of not guilty to narco-terrorism and cocaine importation.

When he tried to keep speaking, saying he had been "kidnapped," Judge Alvin K. Hellerstein interrupted.

"I only want to know one thing," Hellerstein said. "Are you Nicolás

Maduro Moros?"

"I am Nicolás Maduro Moros," the defendant responded.

It was a collision with a new reality for the ousted Venezuelan leader, an autocrat who was compelled to conform to the rules of the courtroom, where the judge is the highest authority. His expression remained neutral, but his hands were restless — sometimes holding rigid on his chair's armrests, sometimes clasped prayer-like below his chin.

After his capture Saturday along with his wife, Cilia Flores, who was

MADURO, Page A7

Wu: City 'proof of what's possible'

Mayor solidifies leadership, sticks to familiar themes as 2nd term begins

By Niki Griswold and Anjali Huynh

GLOBE STAFF

We're staying the course.

That was the message on Monday from Boston Mayor Michelle Wu, who in her inauguration speech recommitted to familiar priorities without enumerating ambitious new promises or issuing new lines of attack. Instead, she pledged to push Boston toward a greener, more affordable future, even in the face of hostility from the Trump administration.

Boston, Wu said, will "stand as a beacon for freedom and proof of what's possible."

"We will not appease or abet any threat to our city, and we will not wait for permission to build the world our families deserve," Wu said. "Boston will be the proof that the nation we fought for is possible



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

With her hand on a Bible held by her sons, Mayor Michelle Wu took the oath of office Monday at Symphony Hall.

— a place where we take care of each other and take on the challenges that matter the most."

Wu's second inauguration, following a decisive reelection victory last fall, reaffirmed her considerable influence over Boston politics on a day that kept the face of city

leadership largely unchanged and saw one of Wu's allies elected City Council president. Wu was sworn in at Boston Symphony Hall by Sarah G. Kim, an associate justice of the Massachusetts Superior Court, as her two older children, sons Blaise

WU, Page A10

Brown plan seeks to help students, boost safety

By Alexa Gagosz

GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — Three weeks after a mass shooting that killed two students, Brown University officials unveiled a campus recovery plan that includes expanded mental health support, security updates, and a new timeline to reopen the building where the attack took place.

On Monday, as the institution faces federal scrutiny, university president Christina H. Paxson said the initiative, dubbed Brown Ever True, seeks to help coordinate recovery efforts across campus ahead of students and faculty returning for the spring semester later this month.

"There is no playbook for what we have been through as a community. There is no single source of truth for how any of us should heal," wrote Paxson in an email to students and employees Monday. "No 'one path' to begin again, or 'right way' to find peace, solace and joy."

Paxson said Brown is planning a campus-wide service later this month to memorialize Ella Cook and Mukhammad-Aziz Umurzokov, two students killed in the Dec. 13 shooting. Nine other students were injured; they have all been released from the hospital, said Paxson.

The university regained con-

UNIVERSITY, Page A5

For breaking news, updated stories, and more, visit our website:

BostonGlobe.com

VOL. 309, NO. 6

*

Suggested retail price
\$4.00

Vaccine guidelines

The US dropped the number of routine shots it recommends for every child from 17 to 11. **A2.**



NEW YORK TIMES FILE

Three children suffered flu-related deaths in Massachusetts, underscoring the severity of the influenza outbreak. **B1.**

For Drake Maye, the NFL playoffs offer a chance to shine even brighter, Tara Sullivan writes. **C1.**



Take gray'd pains

Tuesday: Cloudy, warmer. High 34-39, low 32-37.

Wednesday: Early rain. Weather and comics, **D5-6.** Obituaries, **C9.**



0 947725 4